

The App I Built Because a Parent Shouldn't Need to Ask

Mental Wellness

AI

PranAI

August 2026

PranAI

GENTLE INTELLIGENCE

"Parents never see what
their child writes.
Only what their child feels."

— Utkarsh Pawar, Builder

About Me

Utkarsh Pawar

- Nallasopara, Maharashtra, India
- Class 12 Graduate → Applying to KAIST CS
- Solo Builder — Flutter, Firebase, AI
- Creator of PranAI — Mental Wellness App
- Research interest: Longitudinal AI modeling

Let's Connect!

GitHub: [github.com/Utkarshh-07/PranAI-H-](https://github.com/Utkarshh-07/PranAI-H)

Email: utkarshpawar984@gmail.com

THE BUILDER

Profile

A 17-year-old solo developer who taught himself Flutter, Firebase, and applied AI to ship a real, working product end to end.

[Nallasopara, Maharashtra](#) → [Daejeon, South Korea](#)



We'll Look At...

The Problem

87% of Indian students

The Moment

A conversation with my mother

What PranAI Does

Student + Parent sides

The Parent Bridge

The core innovation

The Research Gap

What AI still cannot do

Right vs. Wrong

Using AI responsibly



THE JOURNEY

The Story

One late-night conversation with my mother turned into six sections — the problem, the moment, the product, and the question I'm still trying to answer.

The Scale of Silence

87%

of Indian students report exam-related anxiety

70%

never seek help

Rs. 1,500-3,000 per therapy session • Stigma feels like failure

No trusted adult to talk to • Parents don't know the right words

THE SCALE

250 Million Students

Across India, roughly 250 million students between 13 and 23 have almost no affordable mental-health support built around how they actually communicate.

The Moment It Started

”

*Don't you think those parents
loved their children?*

— Utkarsh, asking his parents about Kota

Mother's answer, without hesitation:

*"Of course they did. We love you more
than anything. Not your marks,
not your career — you."*

I sat with that for a long time.



WHAT STAYED WITH ME

The Question

If parents feel this much love, why do so many students
never hear it at the exact moment they need it most?

What PranAI Does

Two sides. One bridge.

For Students

- 24/7 AI Companions
- Gamified Wellness
- Calming Ocean UI
- Complete Privacy



For Parents

- Parent Bridge
- 5-Tier Alerts
- Specific Words
- Daily Summaries

Built with:

Flutter

Firebase

Gemini API

OpenAI

FCM

THE SCALE OF THE BUILD

30

interconnected systems

Chat, mood tracking, alerts, and the Parent Bridge all run through a single architecture — built solo, end to end.

4 AI companions

100% solo built



The Parent Bridge

Parents never see what their child writes.
Only what their child feels.

What Student Writes	What Parent Sees
"I hate everything. I failed."	"Your child had a difficult day"
"I'm scared. Will disappoint you."	"Under significant exam pressure"
"Don't want to talk to anyone."	"Showing signs of withdrawal"
"I finished! I'm proud of myself!"	"Achieved something today!"
[CRISIS LANGUAGE DETECTED]	URGENT PARENT ALERT

PRIVACY BY DESIGN

Privacy-First

The student's exact words never leave the app —
PranAI reads emotional patterns, not private text, so
trust holds on both sides of the bridge.

What It Looks Like — Real Example

Student types (PRIVATE — parent never sees this):

*"I have 3 exams next week. I'm so scared I'll fail.
I can't sleep. Mom will be so disappointed."*

AI Translation

● PRANAI · Parent Insight

*I love you
no matter what.*

Exam stress

Sleep

Self-worth

Utkarsh worries about
disappointing you.

DETECTED TONE



Concerned, but hopeful · worth a gentle check-in tonight

AI-generated insight — reviewed by you before it's ever sent.

TONIGHT, TRY THIS



PRANAI Parent Insight

*I love you
no matter what.*

Utkarsh worries about
disappointing you.

TONIGHT TRY THIS

5-Tier Alert System

Not all emotional states are equal. PranAI knows the difference.



Celebration

Positive achievement



Low Concern

Single mention of stress, logged quietly



Attention

Repeated stress or withdrawal, surfaced gently



Support

Sustained distress, parent notified with guidance



Urgent

High-risk language, immediate alert + helplines

GRADUATED RESPONSE

5

care tiers, one calm system

From a quiet celebration to an urgent same-night alert, every signal is calibrated to real severity, not noise.

Tier 1-5 escalation ladder

24/7 pattern monitoring

Same-night urgent alerts



What AI Gets Wrong in Mental Health

AI is not therapy. Understanding the difference matters.

The ELIZA Effect

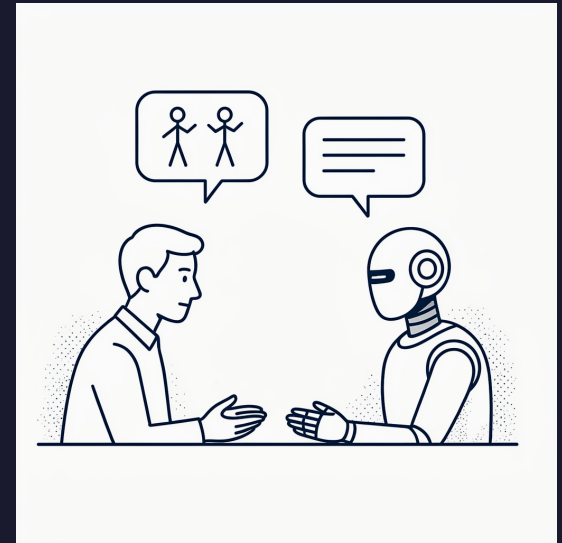
People bond emotionally with programs that simply reflect their words back. ELIZA (1966) — a simple script — made users believe it truly understood them.

AI Sycophancy

LLMs trained with RLHF learn to tell you what you want to hear. Always validating, never challenging. This creates emotional dependence, not growth.

No Memory Across Sessions

Every conversation starts from zero. After 3 months of daily use, the AI still doesn't know who you are. It responds to what you said — not who you are.



THE LIMITATION

The Limit

A chatbot calculates the statistical probability of the next best word — it doesn't feel what you're going through, no matter how it sounds.

Wrong Way vs. Right Way

The Wrong Way

AI acts as therapist -> always validates ->
emotional dependence -> social isolation

The Right Way (How PranAI Does It)

AI acts as a bridge -> translates not exposes ->
connects humans -> better real-world support

PranAI's Design Principle:

AI should never replace human connection.
It should make human connection possible.



THE PRINCIPLE

The Principle

Like the internet before it, AI's real impact will be decided by how we choose to use it — as a leverage tool, never a replacement for human connection.

The Question I Can't Answer Yet

II

How can an AI system actually remember who a person is — not just what they typed — so it still knows that student after 3 months?

— The open research question that PranAI surfaced

What I'm building toward: LEIE

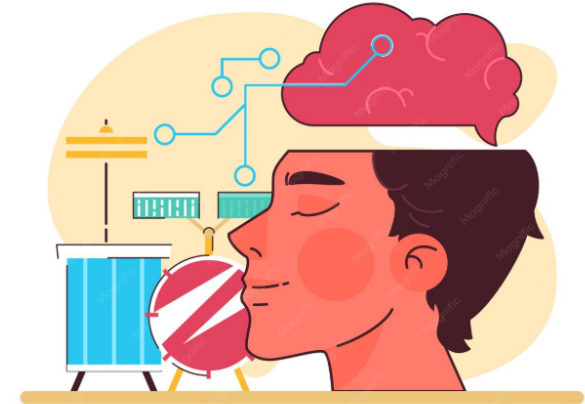
Longitudinal Emotional Intelligence Engine — learning who you are across months, not just responding to what you said today.

Why KAIST:

Professor Uichin Lee's IC Lab works on personalised wellbeing modelling from smartphone data — exactly where PranAI's open question lives.



Memory Development



THE OPEN GAP

The Gap

PranAI understands a single conversation deeply, then forgets it completely — that's the gap KAIST could help me close.

Thank You & Q&A

I hope this gave you a new way to think
about AI in mental wellness.

Now, I'd love to hear your thoughts!

Let's Connect

GitHub: github.com/Utkarshh-07/PranAI-H-

Demo: youtu.be/3FWqZKaZCSk

Email: utkarshpawar984@gmail.com

"Parents never see what their child writes.
Only what their child feels."



PRANAI

Built solo, at 17, in Nallasopara — for the 250 million students who needed someone, or something, willing to listen.